CLAIMS:

1. A multi-fiber connector apparatus (100), the apparatus (100) comprising:

a housing (102) comprising a pair of first multi-fiber connectors (110) operably coupled to a second multi-fiber connector (120) by a plurality of optical fibers (115) within the housing (102),

wherein the first multi-fiber connector (110) comprises a twelve-way multi-fiber connector comprising a first interface (111), the first interface (111) comprising a first pin to pin distance of approximately 4.6 millimeters and a first total terminal spacing of approximately 2.75 millimeters,

wherein the second multi-fiber connector (120) comprises a sixteen-way multi-fiber connector comprising a second interface (121), the second interface (121) comprising a second pin to pin distance of approximately 5.3 millimeters and a second total terminal spacing of approximately 3.75 millimeters, and

wherein the plurality of optical fibers (115) comprises a factor-of-eight optical fibers coupling the pair of first multi-fiber connectors (110) to the second multi-fiber connector (120).

2. The multi-fiber connector apparatus (100) of claim 1, wherein the first multi-fiber connector (110) comprises a first key interface (116), and wherein the second multi-fiber connector (120) comprises a second key interface (126) different from the first key interface (116).

3. The multi-fiber connector apparatus (100) of claim 1, wherein the eight optical fibers at each first multi-fiber connector (110) are operably coupled within the housing (102) to respective holes at the second-multi-fiber connector (120).

4. A fiber optic network (10), the fiber optic network (10) comprising:

a multi-fiber connector apparatus (100) according to claim 1; and

a plurality of fiber array units (20) each operably coupled to respective first multi-fiber connectors (110) at respective first interfaces (111).

5. The fiber optic network (10) of claim 4, wherein at least two of the fiber array units (20) each comprise a transceiver having four receiver optical fibers and four transmitter optical fibers operably coupled to a twelve-way multi-fiber connector.

6. The fiber optic network (10) of claim 5, wherein the plurality of fiber array units (20) is operably coupled to respective first multi-fiber connectors (110) at the multi-fiber connector apparatus (100) via a direct connection of a first twelve-way multi-fiber connector at the multi-fiber connector apparatus (100) and a second twelve-way multi-fiber connector operably coupled to the four receiver optical fibers and four transmitter optical fibers at the fiber array unit (20).

7. The fiber optic network (10) of claim 4, the network (10) comprising:

a multi-fiber connector bundle comprising a mating interface corresponding to a direct connection to the second interface (121) at the second multi-fiber connector (120) at the multi-fiber connector apparatus (100).